

|                                        |                            |                                        |                                  |                                 |                                           |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| HORMUZ<br><b>MEDIUM</b><br>10 articles | MALACCA<br>—<br>0 articles | SUEZ CANAL<br><b>LOW</b><br>3 articles | BAB EL-MANDEB<br>—<br>0 articles | TURKISH STR.<br>—<br>0 articles | PANAMA CANAL<br><b>HIGH</b><br>7 articles |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|

STRAIT OF HORMUZ

HIGH0

MED1

LOW9

Concentration: MEDIUM

**AI ASSESSMENT** U.S.-Iran tensions remain a significant concern in the Strait of Hormuz, as highlighted by a medium-level article from Chosunbiz discussing the potential for increased risk to maritime operations amid rising geopolitical friction. Despite the heightened rhetoric, the overall signal profile indicates a predominance of low-level concerns, with multiple articles reflecting market reactions to the perceived risks rather than immediate threats. Oil prices have shown volatility, with reports indicating a jump to \$71.05 as traders navigate the complexities of the situation. While the geopolitical landscape is fraught with uncertainty, operational posture in the Strait remains stable for the time being.

| PUBLISHED            | HEADLINE & SOURCE                                                                                                                       | CATEGORIES                                        | SIGNAL |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|--------|
| 2026-02-25 06:02 UTC | U.S.-Iran tensions raise Hormuz risk as Korea refiners brace for oil shock - CHOSUNBIZ - Chosunbiz<br>Chosunbiz                         | Chokepoint · Energy Markets · Maritime / Shipping | MEDIUM |
| 2026-02-25 07:40 UTC | The Strait of Hormuz: Where geography becomes a weapon - Middle East Monitor<br>Middle East Monitor                                     | Chokepoint                                        | LOW    |
| 2026-02-25 05:35 UTC | Oil prices jump to \$71.05 as traders weigh Strait of Hormuz risks against inventory gains - Economy Middle East<br>Economy Middle East | Chokepoint · Energy Markets                       | LOW    |
| 2026-02-25 14:30 UTC | Oil Price Holds Near Highs as Hormuz Jamming Risk Keeps Traders on Edge - Investing.com<br>Investing.com                                | Chokepoint · Energy Markets                       | LOW    |
| 2026-02-25 16:20 UTC | February 25: US-Iran War Risk Jumps as Tehran Signals Hormuz Threat - Meyka<br>Meyka                                                    | Chokepoint · Geopolitics / Security               | LOW    |
| 2026-02-25 11:29 UTC | Hormuz risk: The hidden polyester shock to global apparel - Fibre2Fashion<br>Fibre2Fashion                                              | Chokepoint                                        | LOW    |
| 2026-02-25 09:33 UTC | Why Hormuz, not Fordow, is the real centre of gravity in the Iran crisis - Firstpost<br>Firstpost                                       | Chokepoint                                        | LOW    |
| 2026-02-25 07:10 UTC | What Would Happen to the US if Iran Blocks the Strait of Hormuz? - The Business Standard<br>The Business Standard                       | Chokepoint                                        | LOW    |

| PUBLISHED            | HEADLINE & SOURCE                                                                                                               | CATEGORIES                                        | SIGNAL |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|--------|
| 2026-02-25 00:30 UTC | With 50% of India's crude imports passing through Strait of Hormuz, concerns mount over US-Iran standoff - ThePrint<br>ThePrint | Chokepoint · Energy Markets · Maritime / Shipping | LOW    |
| 2026-02-25 00:55 UTC | Iran votes to close Strait of Hormuz - how could it affect global oil and gas? - AOL.com<br>AOL.com                             | Chokepoint · Energy Markets                       | LOW    |

STRAIT OF MALACCA

HIGH 0MED 0LOW 0Concentration: -

AI ASSESSMENTNo material signal activity detected in the last 24 hours. Operational posture stable.

| PUBLISHED                                    | HEADLINE & SOURCE | CATEGORIES | SIGNAL |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------|------------|--------|
| No qualifying articles in the last 24 hours. |                   |            |        |

SUEZ CANAL

HIGH 0MED 0LOW 3Concentration: LOW

AI ASSESSMENTNo material signal activity detected in the last 24 hours. Operational posture stable.

| PUBLISHED            | HEADLINE & SOURCE                                                                                                                  | CATEGORIES                       | SIGNAL |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------|
| 2026-02-25 19:00 UTC | Suez Canal Authority oversees transit of heavy-lift giant HUA RUI LONG - Container News<br>Container News                          | Chokepoint · Maritime / Shipping | LOW    |
| 2026-02-25 14:37 UTC | Egypt's high-speed rail to create 'Suez Canal on rails' linking Red, Mediterranean seas - Dailynewsegypt<br>Dailynewsegypt         | Chokepoint                       | LOW    |
| 2026-02-25 17:00 UTC | CMA CGM, Maersk... Why shipping companies are still reluctant to return to the Suez Canal - The Africa Report<br>The Africa Report | Chokepoint · Maritime / Shipping | LOW    |

BAB EL-MANDEB

HIGH 0MED 0LOW 0Concentration: -

AI ASSESSMENTNo material signal activity detected in the last 24 hours. Operational posture stable.

| PUBLISHED                                    | HEADLINE & SOURCE | CATEGORIES | SIGNAL |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------|------------|--------|
| No qualifying articles in the last 24 hours. |                   |            |        |

TURKISH STRAITS

HIGH 0MED 0LOW 0Concentration: -

AI ASSESSMENTNo material signal activity detected in the last 24 hours. Operational posture stable.

| PUBLISHED | HEADLINE & SOURCE | CATEGORIES | SIGNAL |
|-----------|-------------------|------------|--------|
|           |                   |            |        |

| PUBLISHED                                    | HEADLINE & SOURCE | CATEGORIES | SIGNAL |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------|------------|--------|
| No qualifying articles in the last 24 hours. |                   |            |        |

PANAMA CANAL

HIGH 1MED 0LOW 6Concentration: HIGH

**AI ASSESSMENT** The Panama Canal is currently experiencing significant operational shifts, highlighted by the high-level signal regarding the seizure of ports, which poses a strategic challenge to Chinese interests in the region. The Panama Canal Authority's recent assumption of control over these ports, coupled with the interim operations by Maersk and MSC, indicates a notable restructuring of port management that may impact shipping dynamics. While the overall signal profile remains predominantly low, the high signal reflects a critical juncture that could influence maritime trade routes and geopolitical relations in the coming weeks. Continued observation of developments in this area is essential as the implications of these changes unfold.

| PUBLISHED            | HEADLINE & SOURCE                                                                                                                       | CATEGORIES                                | SIGNAL |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------|
| 2026-02-25 05:15 UTC | Panama Canal ports seized in blow to China - MSN<br>MSN                                                                                 | Chokepoint · Maritime / Shipping          | HIGH   |
| 2026-02-25 17:31 UTC | Panama Canal - galvnews.com<br>galvnews.com                                                                                             | Chokepoint                                | LOW    |
| 2026-02-25 13:42 UTC | Panama Canal Authority Takes Control of Ports - RFD-TV<br>RFD-TV                                                                        | Chokepoint · Maritime / Shipping          | LOW    |
| 2026-02-25 08:43 UTC | Infrastructure and Security: From Panama Canal to Ukraine - We Build Value<br>We Build Value                                            | Chokepoint · Weather / Natural Disruption | LOW    |
| 2026-02-25 10:12 UTC | A Look At A.P. Møller Mærsk's Valuation After New Panama Canal Terminal Oversight Appointment - Yahoo Finance<br>Yahoo Finance          | Chokepoint · Infrastructure / Operations  | LOW    |
| 2026-02-24 22:50 UTC | Panama Canal isn't just geography; it's math   Ray Allegrezza - Furniture Today<br>Furniture Today                                      | Chokepoint                                | LOW    |
| 2026-02-25 00:02 UTC | News Content Hub - Hutchison pushed out as Maersk, MSC assume interim operations at Panama Canal ports - rivieramm.com<br>rivieramm.com | Chokepoint · Maritime / Shipping          | LOW    |

© 2026 Randy Hinton. All rights reserved. Unauthorized reproduction, distribution, or transmission of this brief, in whole or in part, is strictly prohibited without prior written consent. Signal data sourced from Google News RSS feeds via deterministic rule-based classification. Assessments generated by OpenAI GPT-4o-mini. Distribution: Guest